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Robots built using URBI

this year... with ROS inside!). Finally, in Europe, YARP was developed as a similar technology.

Brian Gerkey, who later went to Willow Garage to develop ROS and is now the CEO of Open Robotics, the firm behind the current development of ROS, was one of the leaders of the Player/Stage research project. URBI, on the other hand, was a professional system lead by Jean-Christoph Baillie that performed admirably but couldn't compete with ROS, which was available for free.

That's an essential distinction to make: URBI was (at least) as good as ROS. URBI was very popular among researchers who were working on building robots. You could use URBI to make popular robots such as the AIBO puppy to walk using neural networks, as well as having Aibo dance and perform other tricks. When it came to competing with ROS, however, URBI fell short. URBI featured the same number of debugging tools and documentation as ROS. So, what went wrong with URBI when it came to ROS?

The most astute readers will notice that URBI was not free. It was, in fact, pretty costly. Was it the price that put URBI out of business? Not quite. The lack of community, in my opinion, was what doomed URBI. Building a com-